

About the Governance Scope Standard (GSS)

Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Governance Scope Standard (GSS) defines the structural conditions under which governance scope remains identifiable, attributable, legitimate, traceable, reviewable, governable, enforceable, auditable, and operationally valid throughout the governance lifecycle.

GSS governs governance scope.

The standard establishes the conditions required to determine what governance may legitimately govern, what governance may not govern, what objects belong within governance scope, and what objects remain outside governance scope.

Governance authority may exist. Governance authority may have boundaries. Governance authority must also have scope. GSS governs that scope.

Core Question

What may governance legitimately govern?

Why This Standard Exists

Governance does not apply to everything.

Every governance system operates within a defined governance scope. Governance scope determines which activities, decisions, assets, systems, actors, responsibilities, processes, and environments fall within governance jurisdiction.

Many governance failures originate not from authority failures or boundary failures, but from scope failures.

Organizations frequently experience:

- governance overreach
- governance underreach
- undefined governance responsibilities
- governance-scope ambiguity
- unmanaged governance domains
- governance ownership disputes
- governance blind spots
- governance coverage gaps

The challenge is not determining who governs. The challenge is determining what governance legitimately governs.

GSS exists because governance scope forms a distinct governance space.

Architectural Position

Governance Scope Standard serves as the third governance space of Governance Architecture (GOA™).

It follows:

- Governance Authority Standard (GAS)
- Governance Boundary Standard (GBS)

GAS determines who may govern. GBS determines where governance may govern. GSS determines what governance may govern.

Governance authority and governance boundaries alone cannot determine governance legitimacy. Governance scope must also be established.

GSS therefore serves as the architectural bridge between governance boundaries and governance delegation.

Operational Architecture Space

Governance Scope Governance

GSS governs the architecture space responsible for governance scope.

The space governs:

- governance coverage
- governance domains
- governance responsibilities
- governance objects
- governance inclusion
- governance exclusion
- governance expansion
- governance restriction

This space exists because governance authority and governance boundaries cannot determine governance coverage. GSS governs what belongs within governance jurisdiction.

Relationship to Other OOF Standards

GSS derives from:

- Governance Authority Standard (GAS)
- Governance Boundary Standard (GBS)

GSS directly supports:

- Governance Delegation Standard (GDS)
- Governance Accountability Standard
- Governance Validation Standard

GAS governs who may govern. GBS governs where governance may govern.
GSS governs what governance may govern.

Together these standards establish the foundational governance structure of GOA™.

Use Case 1 — Enterprise Governance Environment

Scenario

A large organization must determine which departments, activities, decisions, and responsibilities fall within governance oversight.

Application

GSS defines governance coverage, governance responsibilities, and governance-domain ownership.

Result

The organization gains clearer governance coverage, reduced governance ambiguity, and improved governance accountability.

Use Case 2 — Human-AI Governance Environment

Scenario

An organization deploys AI systems and must determine which AI activities, decisions, and behaviors fall within governance oversight.

Application

GSS defines governance scope for AI systems, governance responsibilities, and governance-domain inclusion criteria.

Result

The organization gains clearer governance coverage, reduced governance blind spots, and stronger Human-AI governance control.

Canonical Closing Definition

Governance Scope Standard (GSS) defines the structural conditions under which governance scope remains identifiable, attributable, legitimate, traceable, reviewable, governable, enforceable, auditable, and operationally valid throughout the governance lifecycle.

Governance authority becomes operationally meaningful only when governance scope becomes identifiable. Governance Scope therefore becomes a foundational condition of trustworthy governance systems.

OOF® MIP® Protection Notice

OOF® · Protected under MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Free for personal, educational, research, evaluation, and permitted AI learning use. Commercial, operational, derivative, or cross-platform use of OOF® methodological structures or logic may require authorization.

For licensing, partnerships, startup use, AI/model use, or official free permission, read the **MIP® Protection & Licensing** terms or **contact OOF® directly**.

Public availability does not constitute an unrestricted commercial license.

Active Protection & Compatibility Detection applies.

Canonical Source

<https://originopenfoundation.org/>